Samuel William Hanson

sam.hanson@mail.utoronto.ca | samuelwhanson.github.io | Citizenship: United States

EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Faculty of Arts & Science 2025 - 2029
HBSc, Economics Major and Mathematics Major (CGPA 3.9/4.0)
Expected June 2029

- *Relevant coursework completed:* Calculus with Proofs, Intro to Computer Science, Statistical Reasoning
- *Coursework in progress:* Microeconomic Theory, Macroeconomic Theory, Foundations of Econometrics, Multivariable Calculus with Proofs, Linear Algebra I–II

London School of Economics and Political Science 2026
Summer School 2026

- *Coursework Completed:* Financial Markets and the Global Economy: History of Bubbles, Crashes and Inflations (A), Political Economy of Public Policy (A)

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Costly Information and the Rise of Passive Investing Summer 2026
Independent Research Project

- Synthesized costly-information equilibrium models (Grossman–Stiglitz 1980; Gârleanu–Pedersen 2018, 2022) with recent theory and empirical evidence on passive security ownership
- Developed an argument that the defined-benefit to defined-contribution retirement shift drives passive growth through a channel these models do not capture

Perceptions of Tuition-Free Higher Education Winter 2026
Coursework for WRR104: Writing Reports, University of Toronto

- Reviewed and synthesized 11 relevant studies to motivate an original research question
- Designed and administered a survey to 110 respondents to investigate hypotheses
- Cleaned, analyzed, and visualized data in R *(replication code with synthetic data on GitHub)*

SKILLS

Programming & Data Analysis

- R: *data cleaning, regression analysis, data visualization (ggplot2, tidyverse, R Markdown)*
- Python: *unstructured data processing, analysis across varied data structures, data visualization*

Research Methods

- Literature review and synthesis, survey design, academic writing *(samples available)*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Information economics, economic history, monetary economics, financial economics, political economy

AWARDS & HONORS

Dean's List, University of Toronto 2026
University of Toronto Scholar, University of Toronto 2025
International Scholar Award, University of Toronto 2025